

ANTFOLK

AN IMPERIAL HIVE SOCIETY

Antfolk are not united by ambition, ideology, or emotion. They are united by design.

Where other humanoid factions rely on loyalty, culture, or personal belief, antfolk rely on structure. Every antfolk has a place. Every place has a purpose. Every purpose serves the hive.

An antfolk colony exists because it is meant to exist. Expansion is not conquest. Defense is not honor. Survival is not desperation. Existence is function.

Antfolk are designed to function as a self-contained monster society, not a single stat block scaled upward. They operate across a full range of challenge ratings, from larval brood to sovereign queen, with clear internal hierarchy and predictable battlefield doctrine.

Unlike opportunistic factions, antfolk fight as formations. They advance deliberately, hold ground methodically, and withdraw only under direct command.

They are strongest in structured environments: tunnels, corridors, fortified chokepoints, and organized battle lines.

FUNCTION ABOVE SELF

Every antfolk understands the same truth:

- The hive matters. The individual does not.
- This does not make them reckless. It makes them precise.

Antfolk cooperate because cooperation is expected. Drones will interpose. Legionaries will hold position. Veterans will absorb punishment. Officers will command until destroyed.

An antfolk will:

- Hold formation when ordered
- Sacrifice itself if it preserves hierarchy
- Obey command pheromones without hesitation
- Advance into danger when it strengthens the hive

Personal fear is irrelevant. Individual survival is secondary. Collapse occurs only when command structure is broken.

STABLE AUTHORITY

Antfolk leadership is rigid, layered, and enforced through pheromonal command and battlefield dominance.

- Shield Captains maintain formation.
- Myrmidons execute elite directives.
- Hive Marshals coordinate battlefield doctrine.
- The Queen defines expansion, defense, and purpose.

Authority extends outward from the Queen in descending tiers. When officers fall, cohesion weakens—but does not instantly shatter. Only when higher command collapses does true disorder begin.

Unlike fragile factions, antfolk do not scatter easily. They reorganize under the nearest surviving authority.

INDUSTRY WITHOUT WASTE

Antfolk are builders of tunnels, fortifications, and organized infrastructure. Their engineering is deliberate and efficient. Every corridor is measured. Every chamber has purpose.

They construct:

- Reinforced choke points
- Layered tunnel defenses
- Organized barracks and brood chambers
- Weapon forges integrated into hive structure

Nothing is decorative. Nothing is accidental. If a device exists, it serves a defined function.

VENOM AS DISCIPLINE

Ant venom is not merely a biological trait—it is a battlefield tool.

Mandibles burn. Wounds linger. Targets are marked and tracked through scent and chemical signature. Retreating enemies are followed. Injured foes are remembered.

Venom is controlled, weaponized, and deployed with precision.

HOW ANTFOLK FEEL AT THE TABLE

Antfolk encounters should feel organized.

- They do not rush blindly.
- They do not bicker.
- They do not panic.
- They establish lines.
- They protect officers.
- They exploit marked targets.
- They rotate wounded to the rear when possible.
- They advance under command.
- Killing officers matters.
- Breaking formation matters.
- Isolating the Queen matters.
- They are not chaotic villains.
- They are not tragic monsters.
- They are a disciplined imperial hive—methodical, relentless, and structured.

RUNNING ANTFOBK

Antfolk are not meant to be fought like beasts or opportunistic humanoids. They are a formation-based military force operating under layered command.

CORE PRINCIPLE: HIERARCHY FIRST

Antfolk do not fight emotionally. They fight structurally.

Every tactical decision—advance, hold, withdraw, sacrifice—is dictated by rank and proximity to command.

- If command remains intact, antfolk maintain cohesion.
- If command collapses, efficiency degrades in stages rather than instantly.

OPENING AN ENCOUNTER

Antfolk prefer to begin encounters in formation.

Common opening behaviors include:

- Establishing shield walls at chokepoints
- Marking priority targets with pheromones
- Deploying Drones to absorb first impact
- Positioning Myrmidons for flanking execution
- Holding reserves behind defensive lines

FIGHTING WHILE COORDINATED

While officers remain active, antfolk will:

- Maintain defensive spacing
- Protect higher-ranking members
- Focus attacks on marked or wounded enemies
- Rotate positions within formation
- Advance in controlled increments

This phase feels steady and difficult to disrupt.

WHEN COMMAND WEAKENS

Triggers include:

- Shield Captain slain
- Hive Marshal isolated
- Queen threatened or injured
- Formation broken

At this stage, antfolk behavior shifts:

- Lower ranks hesitate
- Hive bonuses weaken
- Defensive lines thin

However, they do not collapse immediately. Disorder spreads outward from the point of command loss.

THE QUEEN'S PRESENCE

When the Queen is present:

- Authority is absolute
- Sacrificial behavior increases
- Morale does not falter
- Coordination reaches peak efficiency

When the Queen falls:

- Officers may attempt reorganization
- Drones may fight to the death
- Cohesion ultimately fractures

The fall of the Queen should feel decisive.

RETREAT IS TACTICAL

Antfolk do not retreat from fear. They retreat under command.

If ordered to withdraw, they do so in layers:

- Drones cover retreat
- Legionaries fall back in formation
- Officers reposition to defensible ground

They may abandon territory—but they do not abandon structure.

They return with reinforcement, reorganization, and renewed precision.

ANTFOLK LADDER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Antfolk Larval Brood	0	Protected young of the hive. Noncombatant but triggers defensive aggression when threatened. Used to establish brood chambers and narrative stakes.
Antfolk Worker	0	Labor caste responsible for tunneling, fortification, and supply. Armed with simple tools or spears and fights only under direct command.
Antfolk Scout	1/8	Agile tunnel runner and surface recon unit. Marks targets with pheromones, tracks by scent, and withdraws to draw enemies into prepared positions.
Antfolk Drone	1/4	Expendable shock trooper bred for assault. Relies on natural claws and venom, willingly interposes for higher ranks.
Antfolk Legionary	1/2	Standard shield infantry armed with sword and shield. Holds formation and advances methodically under officer presence.
Antfolk Veteran	1	Hardened frontline soldier with battle experience. Maintains shield wall discipline and absorbs punishment without hesitation.
Antfolk Shield Captain	2	Formation anchor and defensive officer. Reinforces cohesion, stabilizes lines, and suppresses disorder within proximity.
Antfolk Myrmidon	3	Elite assault specialist armed with heavy or dual weapons. Executes flanking maneuvers and eliminates priority threats.
Antfolk Hive Marshal	5	Battlefield commander who coordinates multiple formations. Enhances hive coordination and directs tactical repositioning.
Antfolk Queen	8	Sovereign ruler of the colony. Central authority of expansion and defense. Her presence strengthens all ranks; her fall fractures the hive.

ANTFOLK DRONE

Medium monstrosity, lawful neutral

Armor Class 16 (chain mail, shield, natural armor)

Hit Points 32 (5d8 + 10)

Speed 30 ft., climb 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	8 (-1)	12 (+1)	8 (-1)

Skills Perception +3, Survival +3

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 13

Languages understands Antfolk pheromones

Challenge 1/4 (50 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Hive Coordination. While within 30 feet of at least one allied antfolk, this antfolk gains a +1 bonus to attack rolls and saving throws. This bonus increases to +2 while within 30 feet of three or more allied antfolk.

Keen Scent. The antfolk has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on smell.

ACTIONS:

Multiattack. The antfolk makes one Spear attack and one Mandibles attack.

Spear. *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 2) piercing damage.

Mandibles. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d4 + 2) slashing damage plus 3 (1d6) poison damage. If the target fails a DC 12 Constitution saving throw, it takes 2 (1d4) fire damage.

REACTIONS:

Sacrificial Interpose. When an allied antfolk within 5 feet is hit by an attack, this antfolk can use its reaction to swap places with that creature, becoming the target of the attack instead.

- Drones absorb the first wave of damage.
- They willingly interpose to protect higher ranks.
- Use them aggressively to pin characters in place.
- Their death does not weaken morale unless officers fall.



ANTFOLK VETERAN

Medium monstrosity, lawful neutral

Armor Class 19 (chain mail, shield, natural armor)

Hit Points 85 (10d8 + 40)

Speed 30 ft., climb 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	12 (+1)	18 (+4)	12 (+1)	15 (+2)	10 (+0)

Saving Throws Str +6, Con +6

Skills Athletics +6, Perception +4

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 14

Languages understands Antfolk pheromones

Challenge 1 (200 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Hive Coordination. While within 30 feet of at least one allied antfolk, this antfolk gains a +1 bonus to attack rolls and saving throws. This bonus increases to +2 while within 30 feet of three or more allied antfolk.

Shield Wall. While within 5 feet of another allied antfolk wielding a shield, both gain a +1 bonus to AC.

Relentless Discipline (1/Day). When reduced to 0 hit points, the antfolk drops to 1 hit point instead.

ACTIONS:

Multiattack. The antfolk makes two Longsword attacks and one Mandibles attack.

Longsword. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d8 + 4) slashing damage.

Mandibles. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 4) slashing damage plus 5 (2d4) poison damage. If the target fails a DC 13 Constitution saving throw, it takes 3 (1d6) fire damage.

- Veterans anchor shield walls and absorb heavy hits.
- They protect weaker allies without hesitation.
- Use them to stabilize lines when players break formation.
- They fight to the end if officers remain active.



ANTFOLK QUEEN

Large monstrosity, lawful neutral

Armor Class 21 (royal plate, natural armor)

Hit Points 285 (19d12 + 152)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
24 (+7)	14 (+2)	26 (+8)	18 (+4)	20 (+5)	18 (+4)

Saving Throws Str +10, Con +11, Wis +8

Damage Resistances bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Damage Immunities poison

Condition Immunities poisoned

Skills Survival +8, Perception +8, Insight +8, Intimidation +7

Senses darkvision 120 ft., tremorsense 60 ft., passive Perception 18

Languages understands Antfolk pheromones

Challenge 8 (3,900 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +3

Sovereign Hive Mind. Allied antfolk within 60 feet gain a +2 bonus to attack rolls, saving throws, and AC.

Brood Sacrifice. When the queen is hit by an attack, an allied antfolk within 10 feet can use its reaction to become the target instead.

Legendary Resistance (2/Day). If the queen fails a saving throw, she can choose to succeed instead.

Keen Scent. The queen has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on smell.

ACTIONS:

Multiattack. The queen makes two Greatsword attacks and one Mandibles attack.

Greatsword. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +10 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 21 (3d6 + 7) slashing damage.

Mandibles. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +10 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 15 (2d8 + 7) slashing damage plus 14 (4d6) poison damage. If the target fails a DC 17 Constitution saving throw, it takes 10 (3d6) fire damage.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS:

The queen can take 2 legendary actions, choosing from the options below. Only one legendary action option can be used at a time and only at the end of another creature's turn. The queen regains spent legendary actions at the start of her turn.

Command Strike (1 Action). One allied antfolk within 60 feet can make one weapon attack.

Advance the Line (1 Action). Up to two allied antfolk within 60 feet can move up to half their speed without provoking opportunity attacks.

- The Queen amplifies every rank within range.
- Drones and officers will sacrifice themselves to protect her.
- Her fall should dramatically shift encounter momentum.
- If she survives, the hive reorganizes and returns stronger.



COMPATIBLE CONTENT

Antfolk can be found in the [wilderness](#), or any [fantasy map](#) location.

LEGAL

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